shot, Kennedy's statement became a tip-off to Khrushchev: he had to complete his secretive game before being fully discovered. Instead of backing off, Khrushchev decided to go on the offensive.

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"PINE FORESTS AND A TEN-FOOT-HIGH CONCRETE WALL SEALED off the huge seafront property from prying eyes," wrote the American journalist Fred Coleman, recalling his visit to Khrushchev's Pitsunda mansion. "Hidden behind the walls were several guesthouses, each too far away to be seen through the trees from its neighbors. The main house, a two-story mansion, contained priceless Oriental rugs, a Japanese garden on the roof and an elevator running up an outside wall. Nearby was a glass-enclosed swimming pool where, in good weather, the roof slid away at the touch of a button to permit bathing in the open air. Telephones were fixed to trees along the garden paths where Nikita Sergeyevich liked to walk."[4]

On September 6, the day after receiving the disturbing news from Washington, Khrushchev welcomed another American, Secretary of the Interior Stewart L. Udall, to Pitsunda. Udall was then completing his tour of Soviet hydroelectric power stations. His unexpected summons to see Khrushchev in his Black Sea villa immediately following Kennedy's statement leaves little doubt that the two events were related. Khrushchev was on the offensive, full of indignation about American actions on the international arena. The thrust of Khrushchev's attack was Berlin. "[H]e reasserted his hard line and indicated the [Soviet-East German] Peace Treaty will be signed," telegraphed Udall on September 7 from the American embassy in Moscow. "He stated flatly he would not allow Western troops [to] remain [in] Berlin and while permitting access for civilian traffic would not allow access for military purposes."[5]

Upon his return to Washington, Udall shared more details about his stormy meeting with Khrushchev. In some ways it was a continuation of the Vienna attack on Kennedy, now conducted through one of his cabinet members. "I know Nixon and Eisenhower, and I must say that Kennedy is better in this respect," began Khrushchev. "As a President he has